



HORIZON FORBIDDEN WEST™

A Post-Apocalyptic Wild West Adventure

By Sameer Mitha | feedback@skoar.in

Horizon Forbidden West is the sequel to one of Sony's most successful open-world games - Horizon Zero Dawn. Forbidden West has been one of 2022's most anticipated games as gamers have been waiting with bated breath to get their hands on the game, especially since the State of Play dedicated to the game showed off not only new machines but also some incredible new combat mechanics. We've been playing Horizon Forbidden West for quite some time now and we can tell you this, if you are a fan of the franchise and are waiting for Aloy's next adventure, then this is definitely the game for you. It isn't without its flaws but the overall package on offer is one that will definitely keep you hooked for a very long time.

STORY

The story of Horizon is... well... complicated. If you haven't played the first game, then we highly recommend you do.

Horizon Forbidden West takes place 6 months after the events of the first game. The world is engulfed in some form of Red Blight that's killing all the vegetation and will eventually lead to the extinction of humanity until our hero Aloy can put a stop to it. Here is where your knowledge of the first game comes into play to get a better grasp of the story. Without spoiling too much, on your journey you realise that you need GAIA, the AI developed by scientist Elizabeth Sobeck to save the world during the first rise of the machines.

As always, through your journey, you will encounter a new threat which we will not spoil here, but we will tell you this, the roots of this new threat are present in the first game. It's like when the developers were writing the story of the first game, they knew exactly where they wanted the story of the sequel to go. The twists and turns that ensue will at times keep you on the edge of your seat while at other times you will know the obvious plot twist is around the corner. It's a very well woven story and

does justice to the deep lore the first game laid the foundation for.

In addition to the overarching 'save the world' story, there are a lot of small stories you will encounter related to the various new tribes in the game along with expanding on the stories of key characters found in the first game. This time there is a new foe in the form of Regalla. She has an immense hatred for the Carja tribe and her origin story is also something you come across in the game adding weight to her motivation. She is a very well written villain and it's easy to understand how her hatred has blinded her to reason.

The only downside to the depth of the lore is you need to be invested in it. Without spoiling anything, the story of Forbidden West will definitely appeal to those that were invested in the lore of the first game.

GAMEPLAY

Those that have played Horizon Zero Dawn will know that the game had its fair share of problems. Traversal was